

TEACUPS FROM AROUND THE WORLD

Tea drinking cups are available in many different shapes, sizes, and materials. Influenced by various cultural requirements and stylistic trends, they are an important part of the tea-drinking experience.



JAPANESE CHAWAN

Meaning “tea bowl” in Japanese, the chawan is a clay vessel often glazed with unusual designs. During the Japanese tea ceremony, or “Chanoyu” (see pp98-103), the host ensures that the most pleasing side of the bowl faces the guest.



TIBETAN TEA BOWL

Po Cha, the Tibetan butter tea, is served in this style of bowl. The wide mouth allows for grains, which are often added to the tea, to be scooped out easily.



RUSSIAN TEA GLASS AND HOLDER

In Russia, tea is traditionally served in a glass cup placed inside a filigreed metal holder, or “podstakannik.” The holder protects the hands from the heat of the glass and improves the stability of the cup.



PORCELAIN CUP AND SAUCER

The cup and saucer is the universally recognized symbol for tea in the West. During the 16th and 17th centuries, porcelain cups and saucers were shipped from China to the West (hence the name “china”). Manufacturing began in England and other parts of Europe only in the mid-1700s, when a Jesuit priest living in China sent the recipe for the porcelain method to France.